JING CHEN

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EDUCATION

Virginia Tech (VT), Virginia, the United States 2024 – present

- Ph.D. in Human Development
- Concentration: Child and Adolescent Development
- Advisor: Dr. Koeun Choi

Southwest University (SWU), Chongqing, China 2021 – 2024

- MSc. Basic Psychology & Cognitive Neuroscience
- MSc. Thesis: Cognitive Mechanisms of Creative Association Processes: A Computational Simulation Based on Activation Spreading; Advisor: Dr. Jiang Qiu & Dr. Qunlin Chen
- Major GPA: 4.23/5.00

Northeast Normal University (NENU), Changchun, China 2017 – 2021

- BSc. Psychology
- BSc. Thesis: Development and Validity of Chinese Word Remote Associates Test; Advisor: Dr. Lili Guan
- Major GPA: 3.79/5.00

PUBLICATIONS

PEER REVIEWED JOURNAL ARTICLES

1. Yang, L., Zeng, R., Wang, X., **Chen, J.**, Gu, J., Fan, J., Qiu, J. & Cao, G. (2025). Cross-domain analogical reasoning ability links functional connectome to creativity. *Thinking Skills and Creativity*, 101808. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tsc.2025.101808
2. Du, Y., Xiao, Y., Yang, H., Ning, Y., Zhi, F., **Chen, J**., Guo, Y. & Chen, Q. (2025). The Box Interaction Game: Action-Based Divergent Thinking Tests for Chinese Preschoolers. *Journal of Intelligence*, 13(7), 75. https://doi.org/10.3390/jintelligence13070075
3. **Chen, J.**, Chen, Q., & Qiu, J. (2024). Development and preliminary exploration of Chinese word remote associates test. *Psychology: Techniques and Application, 12(5),* 283-295.
4. **Chen, J.**, Shi, B., Chen, Q., & Qiu, J. (2023). Comparisons of convergent thinking: A perspective informed by culture and neural mechanisms. *Thinking Skills and Creativity, 49*, 101343. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tsc.2023.101343
5. Ye, W., Li, X., **Chen, J.**, Qiu, J., & Damian, M. F. (2026). Dynamics of Inhibitory Control Processes in a Simon - Switch Task: A Mouse Tracking Study. *Cognitive Science*, *50*(2), e70182. https://doi.org/10.1111/cogs.70182

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

6. **Chen, J**., Hou, J., Cao, Y., Liu, C., Wang, X., He, L., Yang, L., He, R., Chen, Q., & Qiu, J. (under minor revision). Cognitive mechanism of creative thinking: Integrating semantic network and activation spreading model. *Behavior Research Methods*.
7. Liu, L*., **Chen, J*.**, Chen, Q., Huang, J., He, R., Ding, K., He, L., Zheng, M., & Qiu, J. (under second revision). Large-scale brain functional network involved in the generation of melody improvisation. *Psychology of Music.* (* represents co-first authorship)
8. Hou, J., Xiong, X., Chen, Z., **Chen, J.**, He, D., Choi, K., Long, H., & Chen, Q. (under review). Endorsing AI while favoring humans: The dynamics of bias against generative AI in artistic creativity. *Thinking Skills and Creativity.*

9. **Chen, J.**, Wang, Z., Shin, E., Smith, C. L., & Choi, K. (under review). Mapping Parental Factors in Toddlers' Media Use: A Network Analysis Approach. *Media Psychology.*

SELECTED MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPERATION

Chen, J., Hong, Y. J., Choi, K. (in preparation). The interplay between problematic smartphone use, depression, and creative personality in adolescents: A longitudinal cross-lagged model.

GRANTS, HONORS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

GPSS Travel Fund Program (TFP) Awards, VT ($300)	2025
2025 Digital Media and Developing Minds International Scientific Congress Travel Funding ($350)	2025
Graduate Student Budget Board (GSBB) Conference Financial Support, VT ($200)	2025
Laura Jane Harper Scholarship, VT ($1,665)	2024
China National Scholarship ($3,000)	2023
First-Class Scholarship for Graduate Students, SWU	2023
Second-Class Scholarship for Graduate Students, SWU	2022
First-Class Scholarship for Graduate Students, SWU	2021
Presidential Scholarship, NENU	2020
Excellent Student, NENU	2020
Community Engagement Awards, NENU	2020
Fundamental Research Funds for the Central Universities (PI, $1,000)	2019
Excellent Volunteer for the Seminar on Mental Health Education in Primary and Secondary Schools	2019
Outstanding Award in the "Jiaxi Cup" Research Competition	2019
First Class Scholarship, NENU	2018
Third Class Scholarship, NENU	2017

RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research broadly focuses on understanding creativity from a developmental perspective—across both children and adults. My previous research has primarily focused on creativity, cognition, semantic networks, and cognitive neuroscience. Currently, 1) I aim to investigate how the development of children's semantic networks contributes to their creative abilities—particularly how features such as network structure, conceptual associations, and the flexibility to connect distant ideas support creative thinking and storytelling. In addition, 2) I am interested in the complexity of the internal family media ecology, particularly how interconnected family factors collectively shape young children's digital media use. Building on this, 3) I am also interested in how child-AI systems can be designed to effectively scaffold children's creative processes by expanding their semantic space, offering personalized feedback, and encouraging flexible idea generation.

PEER-REVIEWED CONFERENCES PRESENTATIONS

1. **Chen, J.**, Wang, Z., Shin, E., Smith, C. L., & Choi, K. (2026, June 21 – 25). *Mapping parental factors in toddlers' media use: A network analysis approach* [Poster presentation]. 28th Biennial Meeting of the International Society for the Study of Behavioural Development, Incheon, South Korea.
2. **Chen, J.**, Özcan, M. Ş., & Choi, K. (2026, April 9 – 11). *Examining interrelations among temperament, media use, and behavioral problems in early childhood* [Poster presentation]. Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Development Society, Montréal, Canada.
3. **Chen, J.**, Wang, Z., Shin, E., Smith, C. L., & Choi, K. (2025, May 1-3). *Parental beliefs about media's value in creativity: The role of media interactivity, motives, and openness* [Poster presentation]. Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development, Minneapolis, MN. United States.
4. **Chen, J.**, Hong, Y. J., & Choi, K. (2025, July 13-16). *The interplay between problematic smartphone use, depression, and creative personality in adolescents: A longitudinal cross-lagged model* [Flash talk presentation]. Digital Media and Developing Minds International Scientific Congress, Washington, D.C. United States.
5. **Chen, J.**, Chen, Q., & Qiu, J. (2023, April 26). *Comparisons of convergent thinking: A perspective informed by culture and neural mechanisms* [Poster presentation]. International Joint Forum for Doctoral Students in Psychology, Brain and Cognition, Beijing China.

6. **Chen, J.**, Chen, Q., Qiu, J. (2023, June 1). *A review and meta-analysis of convergent thinking: A perspective informed by culture and neural mechanisms* [Oral presentation]. UK Creativity Researchers Annual Conference, Virtual.

7. **Chen, J.**, Tian, D., Yang, L., Chen, Q., Qiu, J. (2023, July 16-18). *The Development of Chinese Word Remote Association Test and the Influence of Conceptual Semantic Network Structure on Creative Association Experiences* [Oral presentation]. The 9th National Conference on Creativity in China: Research on Creativity and Innovative Education in the Era of Artificial Intelligence, Chongqing. China

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Coginitive Developmental Science Lab | PI: Prof. Koeun Choi Virginia, USA

***Graduate Research Assistant**, 08/2024 – Present*

- Parental Influence on Child Screen Use: An Integrated Model of Motive, Beliefs, Personality, and Behavior
- Parental Beliefs about Medias Value in Creativity: The Role of Media Interactivity, Motives, and Openness
- The Interplay between Problematic Smartphone Use, Depression, and Creative Personality in Adolescents: A Longitudinal Cross-lagged Model

Creative & Affective Neuroscience Lab | PI: Prof. Jiang Qiu Chongqing, China

***Graduate Researcher**, Independent Research Projects, 10/2020 – 06/2024*

- Development and Preliminary Exploration of Chinese Word Remote Associates Test
- Exploring the Impact of Semantic Network Differences of Item and Individual
- Differences on Creative Associates Processing and Underlying Neural Mechanism, through behavioral, computational modeling and fMRI study.
- Exploring the Cross-cultural Differences Regarding Convergent Thinking (CT): Meta analysis

***Graduate Researcher**, Collaborative Research Project, 09/2021 – 06/2024*

- Book Chapter - The Psychology of Creativity *(published by National first-class publishing house and one of the excellent textbooks in the National Higher Education Applied Psychology Science)*

***Graduate Research Assistant**, 09/2021 – 06/2024*

- Inhibitory Control's Temporal Dynamics and Neural Mechanisms
- The Shared Cognitive and Neural Mechanism of Domain - general and Visual Art Creativity
- Superior Memory in Open-ended Creative Problem Solving: The Effect of the Subjective Novelty
- Individual Differences of High and Low Creative Individuals in Information Encoding and Its Brain Neural Function Basis
- Behavioral Brain Research Project Chinese Personality (BBP)
- Evaluation and Enhancement Path of Innovative Quality of Teenagers Based on Neuroscience
- Neural Mechanisms of Domain-General and Domain-Specific Artistic Creativity

Divergent and Convergent Thinking Lab | PI: Assoc. Prof. Qunlin Chen | SWU Chongqing, China

***Graduate Researcher**, Independent Research Project, 10/2022 – 06/2023*

- The Influence of Personalities on Creative Achievement (CAQ): The Mediating Role of Creative Self-efficacy (CSE) and Its Brain Mechanism

***Graduate Researcher**, Collaborative Research Projects, 12/2021 – 06/2023*

- The Neural Mechanisms of Music Improvisation and Lyric Composition
- Box Interaction Game: Development of Creative Thinking Assessment Tool for Children Aged 3-6

Jilin Provincial Higher Education Key Laboratory of Cognitive and Brain Science, NENU Changchun, China

***Undergraduate Researcher**, 09/2019 – 05/2021*

- Self- vs Other-Orientation: Impact of Negative Context on Self-Advantage Processing in Face Recognition
- Attitudes towards the LGBT Community among College Students

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant 08/2024-12/2024
HD 3214: Infancy and Early Childhood, Instructor: Alexa Fraley Gardner, VT
Teaching Assistant 01/2025-05/2025
HD3254: Curriculum in Early Childhood, Instructor: Alexa Fraley Gardner, VT
Guest Lecturer, *Real-World Applications of Language and AI Research* 03/20/2025
Psyc 4034: Special Topics in Developmental Psychology, Instructor: Tae-Ho Lee, VT
Guest Lecturer, *Language, Creativity, and AI: How Technology Shapes Children's Learning* 04/22/2025
HD3254: Curriculum in Early Childhood, Instructor: Alexa Fraley Gardner, VT
Internship Mental Health Teacher, Jilin Province Changchun City Automobile District Experimental Primary School 09/2020– 01/2021
Trainee Mental Health Teacher, Jilin Province Changchun No.108 Middle School 09/2019– 01/2020

METHODS

Semantic Network Modeling | Spreading Activation Model | Network Graph TheoryAnalysis | Natural Language Processing (Basic) | Activation Likelihood Estimation (ALE) | Connectome-based Predictive Modeling (CPM) | Multiple Linear Regression | Mixed Effects Model | Latent Class Analysis | Analysis of Variance (ANOVA).

CERTIFICATES

CITI Program Certificate | Computer Level 2 Certificate | English Level 4 Certificate | English Level 6 Certificate | High School Teacher Qualification Certificate - Psychology Subject | Mandarin Proficiency Certificate.

SKILLS

- **Languages:** Mandarin (native), English (fluent)
- **Computer Skills:** MATLAB, SPSS, E-Prime, Mplus, R, Python